

Google Earth

If you want an aerial view of the world, right up to street level—where you can make out cars and even people—look no further than Google Earth. This is an application that gives you a 3D view of the earth. It enables you to see high-resolution aerial and satellite imagery of the planet and much more. Uses range from fulfilling the insatiable curiosity of the armchair traveller to more serious professional and official uses. In rural India, farmers are using Google Earth pictures to prove land claims!

8.1 Installation And Basic Requirements

The software is available in three versions: Google Earth, Google Earth Plus, and Google Earth Pro. Plus and Pro are paid versions that support advanced capabilities useful for the avid traveller, professional, or for organisations that need geographic information. To learn more about their capabilities, visit <http://earth.google.com/products.html>.

Here, we will focus only on the free version, Google Earth. You can download any of the three versions from <http://earth.google.com/downloads.html>. There is also a special enterprise version, separate from these “retail versions.”

Google Earth is available for Windows 2000 / XP, Mac OS X (10.3.9+), and Linux. To use it, you will need at least a 128 Kbps connection, a computer with at least 128 MB of RAM and 400 MB of free disk space, a 3D-capable graphics card with 16 MB of VRAM, and a screen resolution of 1024 x 768 at 16-bit colour. To download Google Earth (about 15 MB) and get full details of system requirements, head to <http://earth.google.com/download-earth.html>.

To install the Windows version, simply double-click the downloaded .exe file and follow the instructions. To install the Linux ver-